Leaping Michaels

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Leaping Michaels is a conventional 4♣ or 4♦ jump overcall of a weak 2♥ or 2♠. It promises a good two-suited hand with at least 5-5 shape. As an extension of the Michaels cuebid, it's named for the "leaping" or "jumping" aspect of the overcall.

- A 4♣ jump overcall shows clubs and the unbid major.
- A 4♦ jump overcall shows diamonds and the unbid major.

Additionally, Leaping Michaels can be used over minor-suit preempts:

- After an enemy 2♦, a 4♣ jump overcall shows clubs and an unspecified major.
- After an enemy 3♣, a 4♦ jump overcall shows diamonds and an unspecified major.

The 4♣ Jump Overcall

4♣ shows clubs and the unbid major after the opponents open 2♥ or 2♠.

South	West	North	East	South
♠ AKT98	Pass	Pass	2♥	4♣[1]
♥ —				
♦ AT				
♣ KQJT52				

1. Leaping Michaels, showing clubs and spades (the other major).

...And here's an example of Leaping Michaels over a 2♦ preempt. Partner can bid 4♦ to ask for the major suit, if desired.

South	West	North	East	South
♠ —	Pass	Pass	2♦	4♣[1]
♥ AKT98	Pass	4♦[2]	Pass	4♥
♦ AT				
♣ KQJT52				

1. Leaping Michaels, showing clubs and a major.
2. What's your major?

The 4♦ Jump Overcall

4♦ shows diamonds and the unbid major after the opponents open 2♥ or 2♠.

South	West	North	East	South
♠ AT	2♠	Pass	Pass	4♦[1]
♥ AQJ53				
♦ AJT85				
♣ 7				

1. Leaping Michaels, showing diamonds and hearts (the other major).

Here's an example of Leaping Michaels over a 3♣ preempt. Partner is allowed to pass (or raise) 4♦ if he has diamond tolerance. Alternatively, partner may bid 4♥ if he has support for both majors. This asks overcaller to pass or correct to spades.

South	West	North	East	South
♠ AKJ85	Pass	Pass	3♣	4♦[1]
♥ A	Pass	4♥[2]	Pass	4♠
♦ QJT762				
♣ 7				

1. Leaping Michaels, showing diamonds and an unspecified major.
2. Pass or correct

Other Considerations

- Playing Leaping Michaels, a 3♥ or 3♠ cuebid (over 2♥ or 2♠, respectively) shows a strong balanced hand. It asks partner to bid a 3NT with a stopper in the enemy suit.
- See also Phillip Alder's column on Leaping Michaels in the New York Times.

See also

- Colorful Cue Bid
  An older, conventional cuebid to show a two-suited hand based on suit color.
- Copenhagen
  A set of specialized jump overcalls that show two-suited hands.
- Defense to Michaels
  A conventional defense employed by the opening side after an enemy Michaels cuebid.
- Ghestem
  An overcall structure for showing any type of two-suited hand.
- Michaels Cue Bid
  A cuebid of an opposing suit to show a two-suited hand. (The convention that Leaping Michaels is based on.)
- Roman Jump Overcalls
  A set of 2-level jump overcalls that show two-suited hands.